

PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC



CAVES LAUNCHES EURASIA CHAPTER

CAPS has launched its Eurasia chapter and has transformed itself from Consortium for Asia Pacific Studies (CAPS) to Consortium for Asia Pacific and Eurasian Studies (CAVES) to expand its horizon from the Asia Pacific region to Eurasia. In this regard, CAVES hosted an international seminar, titled, “Exploring New Horizons in Nontraditional Security Domains”, bringing together ambassadors, diplomats, scholars, and practitioners to foster mutual understanding and explore areas of cooperation.

Educational Convention-Connecting Pakistan and Asia Pacific

The Consortium for Asia Pacific and Eurasian Studies (CAVES), in collaboration with iae Global, organized an educational convention to empower youth to meet their academic aspirations in a changing educational environment. Together, they aimed to bridge Pakistan with the Asia Pacific region through educational exchanges. The event underscored education as a bridge between Pakistan and the Asia-Pacific, emphasizing academic exchanges as tools for diplomacy and soft power.

CHINESE LOANS ARE MORE COMPETITIVE THAN ADB LOANS

CAVES hosted a roundtable discussion with Adnan Amir, a senior journalist from Nikkei Asia, on the diversifying investment landscape in Balochistan. He discussed that China is encouraging the participation of other partners in Balochistan and that mining is not a sustainable strategy and will not be able to solve Pakistan's economic woes in the long run.



Where Afghanistan Fits in Iran's Changing Regional Playbook

CAPES SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT
DR. MUHAMMAD SHOAIB
WRITES FOR THE DIPLOMAT

<https://thediplomat.com/2025/10/where-afghanistan-fits-in-irans-changing-regional-playbook/>



"Afghanistan occupies a central position in Tehran's changing playbook, as the country presents as both a risk and a buffer. A strong, confident Iran may be risk-acceptant, but a vulnerable Iran is risk-averse and seeks "stability through managed engagement." Iran's ideological ingress and desire to maintain a sphere of influence inside Afghanistan, through the Shi'ite population in the country, can wait. For Iran, peace and stability in the neighborhood have become pivotal after the war with Israel in June 2025. Since the war, its concerns have been redirected inward rather than outward"



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- Neveen Syed received the Japanese Foreign Minister's Commendation for fostering bilateral cultural exchange.
- Tim Kane Appointed as Australia's Next High Commissioner to Pakistan.
- Pakistani scholar Areej Sabir wins double honours in China.
- Vietnamese Minister Arrives in Pakistan for PTA Talks.
- Pakistan's Information Minister Attaullah Tarar met Russian Ambassador Albert Khorev in Islamabad.
- Russia highlights importance of Pakistan ties at CAPES Eurasia Chapter launch.
- Investment Minister Qaiser Ahmed met with the Vietnamese ambassador to explore new bilateral investment and trade avenues.
- Japan's JBIC joins Reko Diq lender group.
- Malaysian PM Ibrahim asks more aggressive policy to reignite ties between Malaysia and Pakistan.
- Japan Embassy hosts cultural exchange event in Islamabad.
- Russia to supply RD-93MA engines for Pakistan's JF-17 Block III.
- Pakistan defeats New Zealand in ATF U-12 tennis.

<https://caspak.org/>

Lost accord: Collapse of Pakistan-Afghanistan peace hopes

CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY
UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/lost-accord-collapse-of-pakistan-afghanistan-peace-hopes>



"The military and diplomatic developments between Afghanistan and Pakistan have increased the threat of rising tensions in South Asia. Earlier this month, Pakistan and the Taliban acted with consideration in Doha, offering an opportunity for regional stability brokered with the support of Qatar and Türkiye. However, the next phase of talks in Türkiye collapsed under the Istanbul process. Both countries blame each other for adjourning the dialogues. As a side note for future peace talks, the sensitivities of both states must be taken into consideration."

Why the Vietnam-Pakistan trade pact matters

CAPES RESEARCHER
HADIA ALLAUDIN
WRITES FOR MODERN DIPLOMACY

<https://moderndiplomacy.eu/2025/10/17/why-the-vietnam-pakistan-trade-pact-matters/>



"Vietnamese trade minister Nguyễn Hồng Diên arrived in Pakistan on 13 October to discuss the launch of PTA with Pakistan. Both nations are exploring the launch of a preferential trade agreement, and this visit carries the potential to shape the economic dynamics across Asia. Pakistan is diversifying its trade options beyond traditional partners and considers Vietnam as a gateway to ASEAN."

South Asian Community and Australia's battle against Neo-Nazis

CAPES RESEARCHER
YUSRA SARWAR
WRITES FOR PAKISTAN TODAY

<https://www.pakistantoday.com.pk/2025/10/02/south-asian-community-and-australias-battle-against-neo-nazis/>



"Australia, the land of cultures and diversity, is slowly sinking into the colours of far-right extremism. Anti-immigration protests rose on the streets of Australia, including Melbourne, Perth, Sydney, and Canberra, over the clash of values and ethnicity under the 'March for Australia' slogan. The protests clearly showcased the rise of right-wing extremism within a segment of the public. The anti-immigration rally was more of an anti-brown rally, especially targeting the South Asian community."

NOVEMBER 12, 2025